

one year.<sup>14</sup> That's who people like Trout might compare their incomes to. And the hedge fund manager who makes \$340 million per year compares himself to the top five hedge fund managers, who earned at least \$770 million in 2018. Those top managers can look ahead to people like Warren Buffett, whose personal fortune increased by \$3.5 billion in 2018. And someone like Buffett could look ahead to Jeff Bezos, whose net worth increased by \$24 billion in 2018—a sum that equates to more per hour than the “rich” baseball player made in a full year.

The point is that the ceiling of social comparison is so high that virtually no one will ever hit it. Which means it's a battle that can never be won, or that the only way to win is to not fight to begin with—to accept that you might have enough, even if it's less than those around you.

A friend of mine makes an annual pilgrimage to Las Vegas. One year he asked a dealer: What games do you play, and what casinos do you play in? The dealer, stone-cold serious, replied: “The only way to win in a Las Vegas casino is to exit as soon as you enter.”

That's exactly how the game of trying to keep up with other people's wealth works, too.

### **3. “Enough” is not too little.**

The idea of having “enough” might look like conservatism, leaving opportunity and potential on the table.

I don't think that's right.

“Enough” is realizing that the opposite—an insatiable appetite for more—will push you to the point of regret.

The only way to know how much food you can eat is to eat until you're sick. Few try this because vomiting hurts more than any meal is good. For some reason the same logic doesn't translate to business and investing, and many will only stop reaching for more when they break and are forced to. This can be as innocent as burning out at work or a risky investment allocation you can't maintain. On the other end there's Rajat Guptas and Bernie Madoffs in the world, who resort to stealing because every dollar is worth reaching for regardless of consequence.